

Interactive Whole-House Natural Gas Pressure Test Plan

Tuesday prep + Wednesday county inspection plan.

Important: Confirm the exact pressure, test duration, gauge type, and appliance-disconnect requirements with El Dorado County before starting.

Safety Notice: Natural gas work can be dangerous. Do not pressure-test the gas meter, PG&E side, or connected appliances. The goal is to test the house gas piping only. If you smell gas after returning service, leave the area and call 911 or PG&E.

Disclaimer: This is a planning and tracking tool, not a substitute for a licensed plumber, PG&E requirements, or El Dorado County code. If gas odor is present after return to service, leave the area and call PG&E or 911.

Overall Schedule

Done	Day	Task
■	Already Completed	PSI gauge and gas-rated yellow PTFE tape ordered.
■	Tuesday Morning	Schedule county inspection for Wednesday. Complete walk-through of all appliance connections and confirm remaining parts/supplies.
■	Tuesday Afternoon	Shut off gas, disconnect/cap appliances, install gauge, pressurize, and leak-check system.
■	Wednesday	County inspection of pressurized gas piping.
■	Wednesday Afternoon	After inspection passes: depressurize, reconnect appliances, leak-check, purge air, and restart appliances safely.

Test Objective

The purpose is to pressure-test the **house gas piping system**, not the appliances, not the flexible appliance connectors, and not the gas meter.

Correct concept:

Meter / utility side: shut off and isolated.

House piping side: disconnected from meter, capped at appliance branches, connected to pressure gauge, and pressurized with air.

- Do not pressurize the gas meter or PG&E side.
- Only test the house-side gas piping.
- Disconnect/cap appliance branches rather than pressure-testing appliances.

Appliances Included

Done	Appliance	Likely Location	Required Test Preparation
■	Indoor Fireplace	Living room / fireplace area	Shut off fireplace gas valve. Disconnect and cap accessible house-side gas line if possible.
■	Stove	Kitchen	Pull stove carefully. Disconnect flex line. Cap or plug house-side gas valve or pipe.
■	Dryer	Laundry room	Disconnect flex line. Cap or plug house-side gas valve or pipe.
■	HVAC / Furnace	Attic, garage, closet, or crawlspace	Disconnect gas connection or union. Cap or plug house-side pipe or valve.
■	Water Heater	Garage, closet, or mechanical area	Disconnect appliance connector. Cap or plug house-side gas pipe or valve.

Parts List

Main Test Gauge Setup

Done	Item	Qty	Status
■	0–15 PSI gas pressure test gauge assembly with Schrader valve	1	Ordered. Main county inspection gauge and air-fill point.
■	Gas-rated yellow PTFE tape	1 roll	Ordered. For tapered NPT pipe threads only.
■	Gas-rated pipe dope / thread sealant	1	For sealing threaded gas fittings.
■	Adapters for house-side meter connection	As needed	To connect gauge assembly to house piping after disconnecting from meter.
■	Extra black iron or brass plugs/caps	Assorted	For unused openings or gauge adapter setup.

Appliance Capping Parts

Done	Item	Qty	Notes
■	1/2-inch black iron pipe caps	4	For capping male NPT pipe threads.
■	1/2-inch black iron pipe plugs	4	For plugging female NPT pipe threads.
■	3/4-inch black iron pipe caps	2	For larger pipe branches if present.
■	3/4-inch black iron pipe plugs	2	For larger female threaded openings if present.
■	3/8-inch flare caps	2	For smaller flare-type appliance connections.
■	1/2-inch flare caps	4	Common for stove/dryer-style appliance connections.
■	Short 1/2-inch black iron nipples	2–4	Useful for adapting odd connections.
■	Short 3/4-inch black iron nipples	1–2	Useful near meter or larger branches.
■	1/2-inch gas shutoff valve	1 backup	In case an old appliance valve leaks or breaks.
■	3/4-inch gas shutoff valve	1 backup	Backup for larger branch or meter-side work.

Tools and Safety Supplies

Done	Item	Qty	Purpose
■	Gas leak detector solution	1 bottle	To check all fittings, caps, plugs, and reconnections.
■	Spray bottle with soapy water	1	Backup leak-detection method.
■	Pipe wrenches	2	Use one to hold back and one to turn.
■	Adjustable wrenches	2	For appliance connectors and smaller fittings.
■	Bike pump or small compressor with regulator	1	To pressurize the system with air.
■	Flashlight or headlamp	1	For furnace, water heater, fireplace, and tight areas.
■	Gloves and eye protection	1 set	General safety while working and pressurizing.
■	Painter's tape or tags	1 roll	Mark each appliance as disconnected/capped.
■	Notebook or phone photo log	1	Track every cap, plug, and reconnection.

Important: NPT pipe caps/plugs and flare caps are not the same. Do not force the wrong cap onto the wrong fitting. Do not use tape or pipe dope on flare faces, union faces, compression fittings, or gasketed connections.

Tuesday Morning Walk-Through

- Locate each gas appliance: fireplace, stove, dryer, HVAC/furnace, and water heater.
- Take a photo of the shutoff valve at each appliance.
- Take a photo of the flex connector or hard-pipe connection.
- Identify whether each connection is pipe thread, flare, union, or flex connector.
- Confirm access to the gas meter and the house-side meter connection.
- Schedule the county inspection for Wednesday.
- Confirm county-required test pressure and duration.

Tuesday Afternoon Work Plan

Step 1: Prepare and Stage

- Stage all parts, tools, caps, plugs, gauge, and leak-check supplies.
- Confirm county inspection is scheduled for Wednesday.

Step 2: Shut Off Gas at the Meter

- Turn off all gas appliances.
- Shut off the gas at the meter/service valve.
- Verify you will not pressurize the PG&E meter or utility side.

Step 3: Disconnect and Cap Each Appliance

Done	Appliance	Action
■	Water Heater	Turn off local valve. Disconnect appliance connector. Cap/plug house-side outlet.
■	HVAC / Furnace	Turn off local valve. Disconnect gas connection or union. Cap/plug house-side outlet.
■	Dryer	Turn off dryer gas valve. Disconnect flex line. Cap/plug house-side outlet.
■	Stove	Pull stove carefully. Turn off valve. Disconnect flex line. Cap/plug house-side outlet.
■	Indoor Fireplace	Turn off fireplace gas valve. Cap accessible house-side gas line if possible.

Fireplace caution: The fireplace may be the most difficult appliance to cap if the connection is hidden or inaccessible. If you cannot clearly identify the safe cap point, stop and get guidance before pressurizing.

Step 4: Disconnect House Piping from the Meter

- Separate the house-side gas piping from the meter outlet.
- Keep the meter and utility side isolated.
- Prepare the house-side piping connection for the test gauge.

Step 5: Install the Test Gauge

- Install the 0–15 PSI gas pressure test gauge assembly on the house-side piping.
- Use gas-rated tape or pipe dope only on tapered NPT threads.
- Confirm the Schrader valve or air-fill valve is accessible.
- Confirm there are no open ports.

Step 6: Pressurize Slowly

Done	Pressure	Action
■	2–3 PSI	Stop and check the gauge/test assembly for leaks.
■	5 PSI	Stop and check caps/plugs at each appliance.
■	10 PSI or county-required pressure	Stop pumping and watch the gauge.

Do not over-pressurize. Use only the pressure required by the county.

Step 7: Leak-Check All Connections

- Spray gauge/test assembly.
- Spray meter/house-side test connection.
- Spray water heater cap/plug.
- Spray HVAC/furnace cap/plug.
- Spray dryer cap/plug.
- Spray stove cap/plug.
- Spray fireplace valve/cap area.
- Spray visible unions, tees, elbows, couplings, sediment traps, and valves.

Step 8: Let the Gauge Sit and Monitor

- Reach required pressure and stop pumping.
- Take a photo of the gauge.
- Watch for pressure drop.
- If the gauge drops, find and fix the leak before leaving overnight.
- Leave system pressurized overnight. Record gauge reading and time for comparison Wednesday morning.

Overnight hold: The system should hold pressure overnight. Check the gauge Wednesday morning before the inspector arrives. If pressure dropped overnight, investigate and fix before the inspection.

Wednesday — County Inspection Readiness

- Check gauge Wednesday morning — confirm pressure held overnight.
- Permit or job card ready.
- Gauge visible and accessible.
- Appliances disconnected and capped.
- Gauge holding required pressure.
- Access available to fireplace, stove, dryer, HVAC/furnace, and water heater areas.

Meter Disconnect, Bleed-Off, and Return-to-Service Safety Notes

High-risk work area: Opening the house gas piping at the meter, bleeding natural gas, reconnecting the meter connection, purging air, and relighting appliances are the highest-risk steps in this plan. Use this section as a safety checklist, not as a substitute for a licensed plumber, PG&E guidance, or El Dorado County requirements.

Before disconnecting from the meter

- Confirm with El Dorado County that the gauge may be installed at the house-side meter connection.
- Confirm required test pressure, duration, and gauge range before starting work.
- Confirm you are only working on the house-side piping and not disturbing the PG&E/utility side.
- Confirm all gas appliances are turned off before shutting down gas.
- Ventilate nearby areas and remove ignition sources before opening gas piping.
- Have PG&E/emergency contact information available before starting.

Meter-side disconnect concept

Concept only: The meter/utility side stays shut off and isolated. The test gauge connects to the **house-side piping only**. Do not pressurize the meter or PG&E side.

- Gas shut off at the meter/service valve.
- House-side meter connection clearly identified.
- Utility/meter side left isolated and not pressurized.
- Gauge/test assembly planned for the house-side piping connection.
- Confirmed: no air pressure will be applied through the gas meter.

Bleeding / depressurizing before opening piping

Do not casually vent gas indoors. Any residual gas must be handled safely. If you are unsure how to safely depressurize the house-side piping, stop and have a plumber handle this step.

- Meter/service valve confirmed off before opening the house-side piping.
- All appliance controls and local shutoff valves confirmed off.
- No open flames, smoking, sparks, or ignition sources nearby.
- Residual gas handled only in a safe, ventilated manner.
- If gas odor is strong, persistent, or uncontrolled: stop, leave, and call PG&E/911.

After county inspection: releasing test air pressure

- Inspection passed before releasing test pressure.
- Test air released in a controlled way from the house-side piping.
- Gauge reads zero before removing gauge/test assembly.
- Gauge/test assembly removed only after pressure is fully released.

Return-to-service safety notes

Important: After the pressure test, the gas piping contains air, not fuel gas. Reconnecting and purging must be done carefully. A plumber is strongly recommended for reconnecting, purging, relighting, and confirming safe operation.

- House piping reconnected to meter connection.
- Meter/house-side reconnection leak-checked with approved leak detector solution.
- Fireplace, stove, dryer, HVAC/furnace, and water heater reconnected.
- Every appliance reconnection leak-checked before operation.
- Air purged from gas lines safely before normal operation.
- Each appliance restarted according to manufacturer instructions.
- Each appliance observed for normal flame/operation after restart.
- Final odor/leak check completed after all appliances are back in service.

Wednesday Afternoon — After the Inspection Passes

Do not simply remove the gauge and turn gas back on. The system will contain air from the pressure test. Reconnection, leak-checking, purging, and relighting must be done carefully.

- Release the test air pressure.
- Remove the pressure test gauge.
- Reconnect the house piping to the meter.
- Reconnect the water heater.
- Reconnect the HVAC/furnace.
- Reconnect the dryer.
- Reconnect the stove.
- Reconnect the indoor fireplace.
- Leak-check every reconnected fitting using leak detector solution.

- Purge air from the gas lines safely.
- Relight or restart each appliance according to manufacturer instructions.
- Confirm every appliance operates normally.

Final Checklist

- County pressure/duration requirement confirmed.
- All parts and supplies acquired.
- All appliances photographed before work.
- Gas shut off at meter.
- Water heater disconnected/capped.
- HVAC/furnace disconnected/capped.
- Dryer disconnected/capped.
- Stove disconnected/capped.
- Fireplace disconnected/capped or safely isolated.
- House piping disconnected from meter.
- Meter disconnect, bleed-off, and return-to-service safety checklist reviewed.
- Gauge installed on house-side piping.
- System pressurized to required pressure.
- All caps/plugs leak-checked.
- Gauge holding pressure before inspection.
- Inspection passed.
- System depressurized after inspection.
- Meter connection restored.
- All appliances reconnected.
- All reconnected joints leak-checked.
- Appliances purged/restarted safely.

Emergency Reminder: If you smell gas, hear gas escaping, feel unsure about a connection, or cannot safely relight an appliance, stop immediately. Leave the area and call PG&E or 911.